

UNIT - IV : CARE OF PATIENTS

Care of patients means looking after the patient physically, mentally, socially and emotionally.

COMPONENTS OF PATIENT CARE

1. Therapeutic environment
2. Comfort
3. Safety
4. Communication

THERAPEUTIC ENVIRONMENT

Therapeutic environment is a safe, clean, supportive setting that promotes healing and well-being of patients.

COMPONENTS

- Physical environment -
 - Cleanliness and hygiene
 - Regular cleaning of wards, beds, medical equipment.
 - Proper biomedical waste disposal.
 - Prevention of hospital acquired infection.
 - Ventilation
 - Adequate airflow reduces infection risks
 - Remove odours and maintain freshness.
 - Lighting
 - Prefer natural light.
 - Adequate artificial lighting for procedure
 - Avoid excessive brightness causing discomfort.
 - Noise control
 - Minimise noise from staff and machines.
 - Maintain silence during rest hours.
 - Temperature regulation
 - Maintain comfortable temperature.
 - Avoid extreme temperatures that may harm patients.
- Physiological environment
 - Provide calm and reassuring surroundings.
 - Reduce fear and anxiety.
 - Respect patient's privacy and dignity.
 - Encourage emotional support from family.
- Infection control measures
 - Hand hygiene.
 - Use of PPE [personal protective equipment]
 - Sterilisation of instruments
 - Isolation of infectious patients.
- Social environments
 - Respect cultural beliefs and practices
 - Encourage family involvement and care
 - Promote patient autonomy.

SAFETY FACTOR FOR PATIENTS

Measures taken to prevent injury, harm, or complications during patient's care

TYPES OF SAFETY MEASURES

- A. Physical safety -
 - a. Prevent falls - use wide rails, assist elderly or weak patient and keep floor dry.
 - b. Prevent burns
- B. Medication safety

- a. Follow the 5 rights of administration –
 - i. Right patient
 - ii. Right drug
 - iii. Right dose
 - iv. Right route
 - v. Right type
- C. Infection prevention
 - a. Handwashing before and after contact
 - b. Safe disposal of sharp objects
 - c. Use aseptic techniques
- D. Environment safety
 - a. Adequate lighting
 - b. Clutter free environment
- E. Fire safety measures
 - a. Use fire extinguisher
- F. Patient identification
 - a. Use ID bands
 - b. Confirm patient's identity
- G. Legal and ethical safety
 - a. Obtain informed consent
 - b. Maintain confidentiality
 - c. Proper documentation

COMFORT

Intervention aim at relieving discomfort and promoting well-being.

TYPES OF COMFORT MEASURES

- A. Physical comfort
 - a. Positioning – proper positioning prevents complications. E.g. Fowler's position, supine position.
 - b. Pain relief –
 - i. pharmacological – NSAIDS (non-steroidal anti-inflammatory drugs), opioids
 - ii. non-pharmacological – massage, heat and cold therapy.
 - c. Hygiene care –
 - i. Sponge bath
 - ii. Oral care
 - iii. Combing hair
 - iv. Trimming nails
 - v. Changing into clean clothes to prevent infection and induces comfort
 - d. Nutrition and hydration
 - i. Balanced diet, adequate intake
 - e. Sleep and rest
 - i. Provide quiet environment
 - ii. Comfortable bedding
 - iii. Avoid unnecessary disturbances
 - f. Skin care
 - i. Prevent bed sore
 - ii. Reposition every 2 hours, use air mattress
 - iii. Keep skin clean and dry
 - g. Elimination needs
 - i. Assist in urination and defaecation
 - ii. Maintain privacy
 - iii. Use bed pants or urinals

COMMUNICATION

Exchange of information between healthcare provider and patient to ensure effective care

TYPES OF COMMUNICATION

- a. Verbal communication
 - Use simple clear language
 - Avoid medical jargon
 - Speak in patient's preferred language
- b. Non-verbal communication
 - Touch when appropriate
 - Facial expressions
- c. Written communication
 - Case sheets
 - Presentation
 - Discharge summaries

PRINCIPLES OF EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

- Empathy and respect
- Active listening
- Maintain confidentiality
- Honesty and loyalty
- Encourage question

BARRIERS TO COMMUNICATION

- Emotional distress
- Caring impairment
- Cultural differences

Unit - V : NEGLIGENCE

- Negligence occurs where someone's carelessness leads to another person's injury or financial loss.
- In healthcare, negligence can lead to serious harm to the patients.
- Professional negligence is a specific form of negligence where a person with specialized skills fails to perform their duties to the standard expected of their profession
- Elements of negligence - to prove negligence in court , four elements must typically be present.
 - o Duty of care - responsibility to care for someone
 - o Breach of duty - failure to meet standard care
 - o Possession - mistake causes harm
 - o Damage - actual injury or suffer.

PROFESSIONAL NEGLIGENCE

- e.g. doctor, nurse, technician, lawyer, accountant, engineer etc.
- medical malpractice - a surgeon leaving a tool inside a patient, a doctor misdiagnosing a disease condition.

LEGAL NEGLIGENCE

- a lawyer missing a filing deadline that causes the client to lose their case.

FINANCIAL NEGLIGENCE

- An accountant providing incorrect tax advice that leads to heavy government fines.

ENGINEERING NEGLIGENCE

- Designing a building with unnatural flows that leads to a collapse

TYPES OF NEGLIGENCE

In the legal system, negligence is often categorised based on how the fault is assigned.

1. Gross negligence - a severe lack of care that shows a reckless disregard for safety.
2. Contributory negligence - if the injured person is slightly at fault for their own injury. They may be bare from recovering any money at all.
3. Comparative negligence - both the parties are at fault and the compensation is divided according to their degree of fault.
4. Vicarious negligence - when one person is held responsible for negligence of another.
5. Criminal negligence - negligence is so extreme that it becomes crime.

PUNISHMENTS

1. Section 106 BNS - equivalent to 304A IPC
 - a. Used in patient dies due to negligence
 - b. Punishment - imprisonment upto 2yrs or fine or both
2. Section 125 BNS - equivalent to 377 IPC
 - a. Used in minor injury
 - b. Punishment - 6month of imprisonment or fine
3. Section 126 BNS - equivalent to 388 IPC
 - a. Used in serious injury
 - b. Punishment - upto 2years of imprisonment or fine